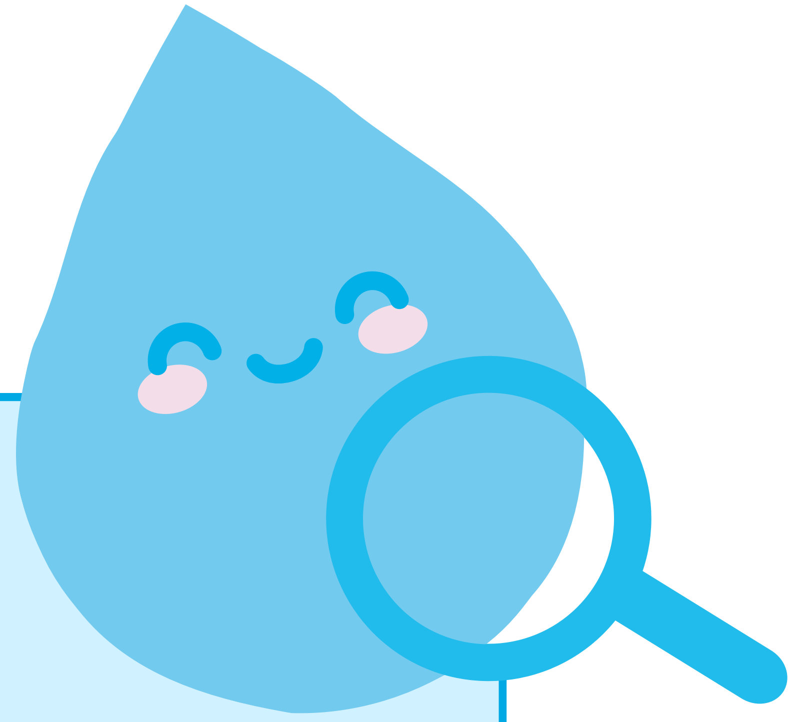
SOURCE TO SOUND

RAINDROP RACERS



Test how rainwater moves across different surfaces

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN IT RAINS?

- Rain can either soak into the ground or flow across the surface

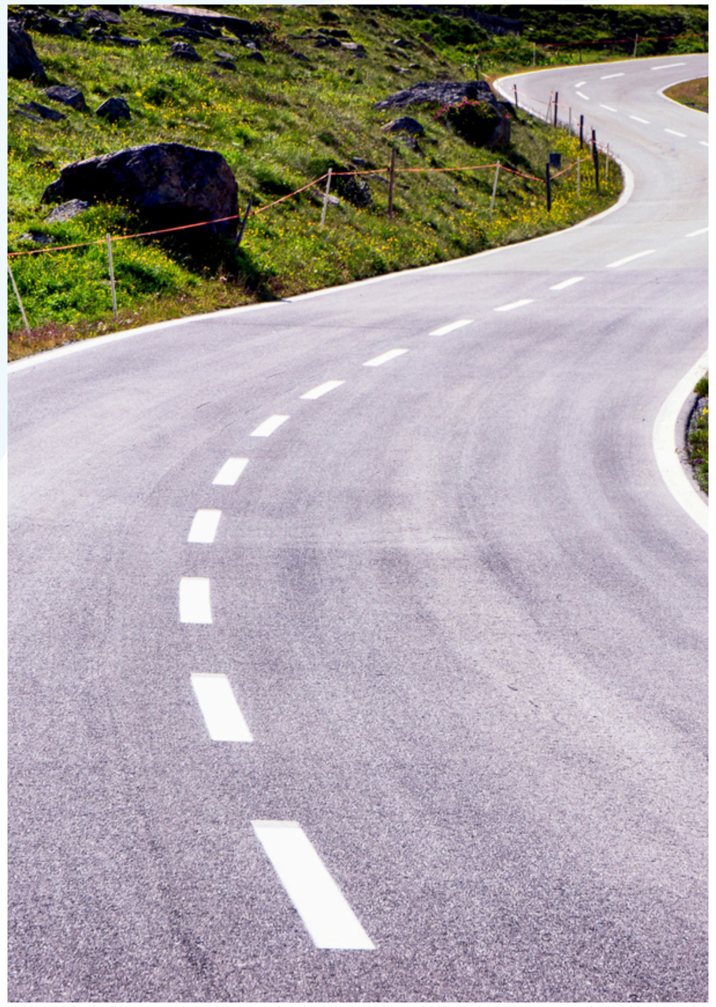
- Water flowing acros roads, sidewalks, and grass is known as <u>surface runoff</u>

- Today, we test which surfaces slow water down and which create fast runoff

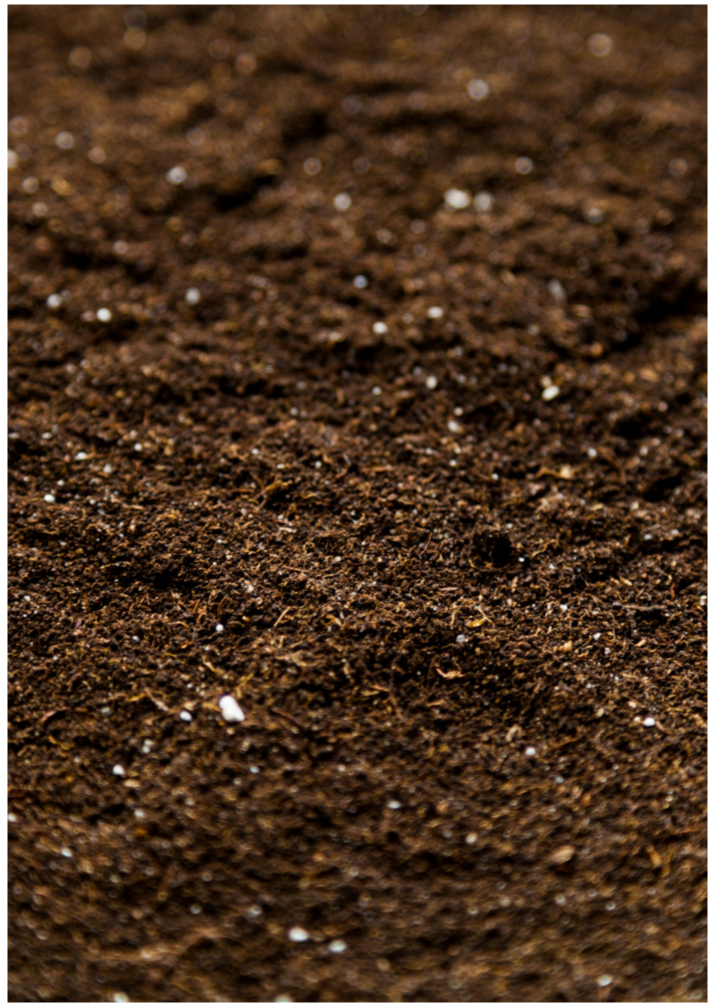
KEY WORDS

Word	Meaning
Absorb	To soak up water
Runoff	Water that flows across the ground instead of soaking in
Impervious surface	A hard surface that water cannot easily pass through

OUR TEST SURFACES



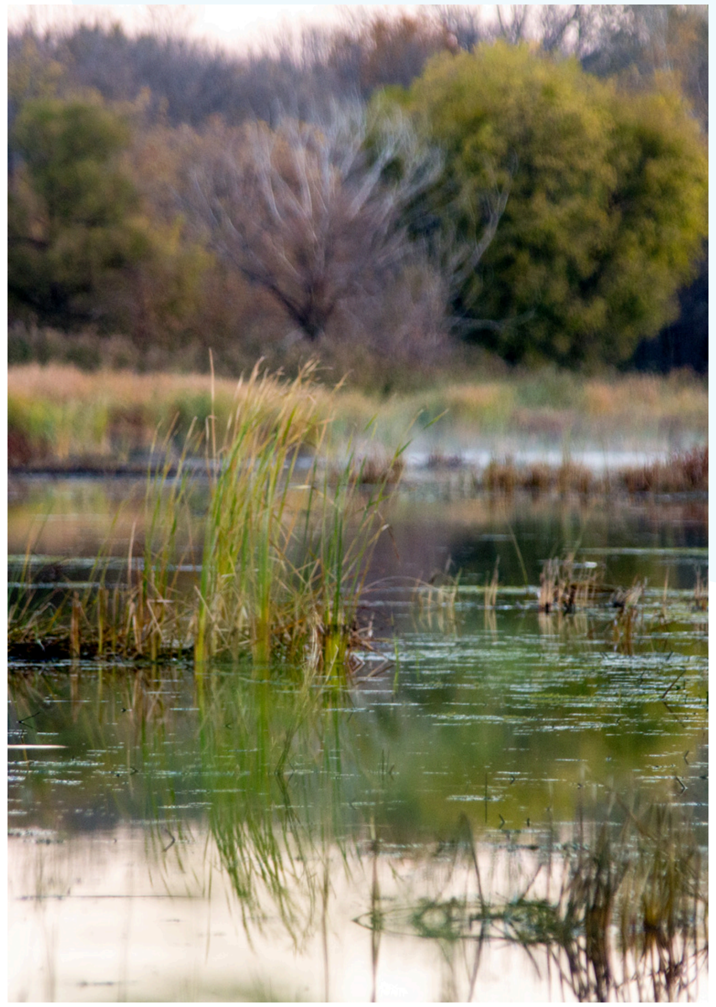
Pavement



Soil

Grass

Gravel



Wetland

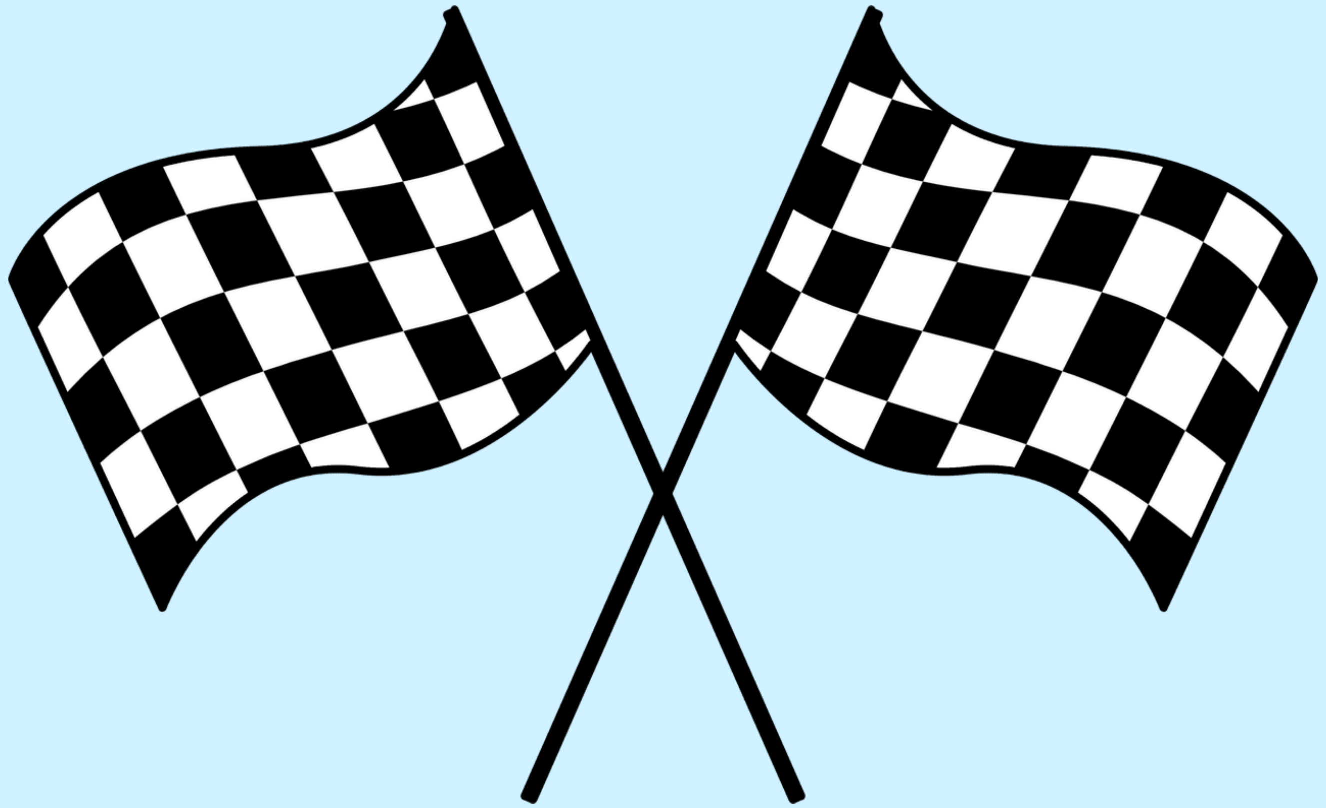
YOUR MISSION

You are a Raindrop Racer. Your job is to test which surface makes water move the fastest and which surface holds the most water

Predictions:

- Which surface do you think will have the fastest raindrop
- Which surface do you think will hold the most water?

LET THE RAINDROPS RACE!



STEPS

1. Pour the same amount of water at the top of each tray
2. Watch how quickly the water moves
3. Observe how much water reaches the bottom
4. Note all observations on observation sheet
    a. Record fast, medium, slow pace

DISCUSSION

Which surface...

1. Had the fastest runoff?
2. Slowed the water down?
3. Held the most water?
4. Held the least water?

RUNOFF VS. ABSORPTION

Hard surfaces like pavement tend to create more runoff

Softer or plant-covered surfaces can slow water and soak it in